

Guidance on using the Article 12 European Assessment tool

The following is a step-by-step manual guide to using the Article 12 European Assessment Tool.

1. Accessing the tool

The assessment tool is accessed at <https://nature-art12.eionet.europa.eu/article12/>.

Welcome to the Article 12 web tool on population status and trends of birds under Article 12 of the Birds Directive

This page gives access to information reported by the Member States and the EU assessments of birds population status and trends made by the European Commission contractors (European Red List Consortium in 2014 and Stichting BirdLife Europe with BirdLife International and IUCN in 2020)

A summary of the methodologies used for the EU population status assessments can be found [here](#) and a step-by-step guide for using the tool can be found [here](#).

Birds population status and trends at EU and Member State level (species by species filter):

- [Birds population status and trends](#)

Birds trends at Member State level (overview of results by Member State):

- [Birds trends](#)

Birds population status and trends at EU level (overview of results) :

- [Birds population status and trends](#)

If there are issues with using the tool, please contact nature.helpdesk@eionet.europa.eu.

The bird's data can be viewed in 3 ways:

- Bird population status and trends
- Bird trends at Member State level (Member State overview)
- Bird population status and trends at EU27 level (Overview of EU status and trends)

To view the overall population status and trends at EU and Member States level on a species by species level, access 'Bird population status and trends'.

2. Birds population status and trends at EU and Member State level (species by species filter)

Selecting 'Birds population status and trend' will lead to the page below with a choice of filters for more information on a specific species.

The filters available are Period (relating to the reporting periods 2008 – 2012¹, 2013 – 2018 and 2019-2024), species name and Sub-specific unit.

Population status and trends at the EU and Member State levels

The Article 12 web tool provides an access to EU assessments and Member States' data compiled as part of the Habitats Directive - Article 12 reporting process. The EU assessments have been carried out in EU 27 for the period 2008-2012, in EU28 for the period 2013-2018 and in EU 27 for the period 2019-2024.

Choose period, species and if relevant sub-specific unit.

Once a selection has been made the breeding distribution of the species can be visualized in a map.

The 'Data sheet info' includes notes for each assessment per species.

The 'Audit trail' includes the methods used for the EU assessment and justifications for decisions made by the assessors.

Period...	Species name...	Sub-specific unit...	
2019-2024	-	-	Filter

¹ There is a reporting period '2008 – 2012bis', which includes the late delivery of Greek data not present in the 2008 – 2012 reporting period.



Population status and trends at the EU and Member State levels

The Article 12 web tool provides an access to EU assessments and Member States' data compiled as part of the Habitats Directive - Article 12 reporting process. The EU assessments have been carried out in EU 27 for the period 2008-2012, in EU28 for the period 2013-2018 and in EU 27 for the period 2019-2024.

Choose period, species and if relevant sub-specific unit.

Once a selection has been made the breeding distribution of the species can be visualized in a map.

The 'Data sheet info' includes notes for each assessment per species.

The 'Audit trail' includes the methods used for the EU assessment and justifications for decisions made by the assessors.

Period...
2019-2024 x

Species name...
Accipiter gentilis x

Sub-specific unit...
Search reported name...

Filter

Accipiter gentilis all others

Accipiter gentilis arrigonii

View data sheet info

Audit trail

Map

Legend: I Increasing S Stable Unk Unknown D Decreasing

In general Member States data were provided at the level of subspecies for all subspecies listed in the Annexes of the Directive, subspecies or population listed on the Annex III of the AEWA convention and their subspecific counterparts. The EU assessment was in most cases done at both species and subspecies level. For filtering the 'species' level assessments 'Sub-specific unit' filter does not need to be set.

The Sub-specific unit field will not have information for most of the species, but only for cases, where there is a separate EU assessment and/or Member State data at the subspecies or population level (see above) or there is a specific restriction for use of the species name (see below).

Period...
2019-2024 x

Species name...
Acanthis flammea x

Sub-specific unit...
Search reported name...

Filter

Acanthis flammea [including cabaret and exilipes]

View data sheet info

Audit trail

Map

Legend: I Increasing S Stable Unk Unknown D Decreasing F Fluctuating U Uncertain

Codes 'PT', 'ES' correspond to Portugal mainland (excluding Azores-PTAC and Madeira-PTMA) and Spain mainland (excluding Canary Islands).

All Member States reports on the selected species are shown first. The table is divided from the left into: Breeding population (size and trend), Breeding distribution (size and trend) Winter population where reported (size and trend), gridded breeding distribution area and the sub-specific unit. For the assessments at the species level the reported data were merged into one table. Sub-specific unit indicate which subspecies was reported from Member States, e.g. *Accipiter gentilis arrigonii* was reported from FR.

Legend: ■ Increasing ■ Stable ■ Unk Unknown ■ Decreasing ■ Fluctuating ■ Uncertain

Current selection: 2019-2024, *Accipiter gentilis*. [Show all](#)

Data from Member States reports

MS	Breeding population											Breeding distribution											Winter population											Breeding area from gridded maps (km ²)	Sup. / adap. notes											
	Population size					Population trend						Distribution size					Distribution trend						Population size					Population trend																		
	Min.	Max.	Best val.	Unit	Type est.	Change %	% MS	SJ period	SJ direction	SJT magnitude	LJ period	LJ direction	LJT magnitude	A area	Z	% MS	SJ period	SJ direction	SJT magnitude	LJ period	LJ direction	LJT magnitude	Z	Min.	Max.	Best val.	Unit	Type est.	Change %	% MS	SJ period	SJ direction	SJT magnitude	LJ period		LJ direction	LJT magnitude	Z	Status	Diversity	% MS					
LU	40	80		p	estimate	genome		2013-2024		-20 18 NA	1980-2024		NA NA NA	1872			2013-2024		NA NA NA	1980-2024		NA NA NA		#																				Accepter genitalic all st		
IT	500	800		p	estimate	roChange	1.0	2013-2024		NA NA NA	1980-2024		-30 -10 NA	2280			2013-2024		-10 0 NA	1980-2024		-30 -10 NA		#																				Accepter genitalic all st		
IE	800	800		p	estimate	genome	1.1	2013-2024		17 124 NA	1980-2024		-72 -47 41	3160	#	0.1	2013-2024		NA NA NA	1980-2024		NA NA -30		#																				Accepter genitalic all st		
CZ	1000	2500		p	estimate	naChang	3.2	2015-2024		NA NA NA	2005-2014		NA NA NA	35000	#	0.2	2013-2024		NA NA 4.98037	1980-2024		NA NA -28.8/66		#																				Accepter genitalic all st		
AT	1000	1500		p	interval	knowledge	2.0	2013-2024		NA NA 0	1980-2024		-70 30 NA	4700	#	0.1	2013-2024		NA NA 15.233	1980-2024		NA NA -16.2032		#																				Accepter genitalic all st		
FI	4200	4619	4430	p	mean	genome	0.9	2013-2024		-22 -7 15			NA NA -37	117600		0.3	2008-2024		NA NA -37	1980-2024		NA NA -37		#																					Accepter genitalic all st	
SI	500	1000		p	estimate	roChang	1.2	2019-2024		NA NA NA	1980-2024		NA NA NA	10100	#		2013-2024		NA NA NA	1980-2024		NA NA NA		#																					Accepter genitalic all st	
NL	1100	2500	2100	p	mean	naChang	3.3	2012-2023		-10 8 6	1984-2023		8.84216 72.365 37.5376	49500	#	0.1	2011-2023		NA NA 0.395706	1977-2023		NA NA 2.88809		#																				Accepter genitalic all st		
HU	1130	1350		p	estimate	knowledge	2.3	2013-2024		NA NA NA	1980-2024		NA NA NA	5700		0.2	2013-2024		NA NA NA	1980-2024		NA NA NA		#																						
BE	810	1140	905	p	estimate	naChang	1.6	2013-2024		0.0027608 0.277483 0.320187	1975-2024		3.90609 6.04242 4.97876	23938			2013-2024		NA NA 0.227325	1979-2024		NA NA 1.26719		#																				Accepter genitalic all st		
HU	1130	1350		p	estimate	unknown	1.9	2013-2024		NA NA NA	1980-2024		-80 57 NA	13056			2013-2024		NA NA NA	1980-2024		-20 -10 NA		#																					Accepter genitalic all st	
SE	4500	9100	8800	p	estimate	knowledge	10.7	2013-2024		NA NA 0	1980-2024		-75 -45 -65	40960	#	1.3	2013-2024		NA NA 0	1980-2024		NA NA 0		#																				Accepter genitalic all st		
FR	6600	12300	8900	p	estimate	method	13.9	2012-2022		NA NA NA	1980-2022		NA NA NA	192000		0.6	2009-2024		NA NA -1	1985-2024		NA NA 8		#																				Accepter genitalic all st		
GB	1300	2500	2000	p	estimate	knowledge	3.1	2013-2024		NA NA NA	1980-2024		NA NA NA	81500		0.2	2013-2024		NA NA NA	2000-2024		NA NA NA		#																					Accepter genitalic all st	
LV	1117	1231	2157	p	interval	knowledge	4.3	2013-2024		52 2 27	2006-2024		-97 52 24	38900		0.1	2002-2015		55.88 -44.97 -50.47	1982-2015		23.13 20.98 22.25		#																				Accepter genitalic all st		
CY	80	120		p	estimate	roChang	0.2	2013-2024		0 10 NA	1980-2024		-20 300 NA	3800	#		2013-2024		NA NA NA	1980-2024		NA NA NA		#																					Accepter genitalic all st	
DE	10000	14930		p	mean	genome	19.3	2010-2022		NA NA -12	1980-2022		NA NA -16	30898414	#	20.0	2010-2022		-10 10 NA	1980-2022		-30 40 NA		#																					Accepter genitalic all st	
IT				p	estimate	naChang	0.5	2013-2024		NA NA NA	1980-2024		NA NA NA	3500	#	57.4	2013-2024		NA NA NA	1993-2024		NA NA -62.2048		#																				Accepter genitalic all st		
UK			500	p	estimate	genome	0.6	2012-2023		98 184 47	1989-2023		NA NA -23	17000	#		2014-2023		NA NA 8	1974-2023		NA NA 70		#																				Accepter genitalic all st		
IE	1000	1200		p	estimate	roChang	1.7	2013-2024		-18 49 13	1980-2024		NA NA 11	46700	#	0.1	2013-2024		NA NA NA	1980-2024		NA NA NA		#																				Accepter genitalic all st		
FR	70	100		p	estimate	naChang	54.8	2013-2024		NA NA NA	1980-2024		NA NA NA	2600	#	42.6	2013-2023		NA NA NA	1980-2023		NA NA NA		#																					Accepter genitalic all st	
IT	430	740		p	estimate	roChang	0.9	2013-2024		NA NA NA	1980-2024		NA NA NA	25600			2013-2024		NA NA NA	1993-2024		NA NA -70.1811		#																					Accepter genitalic all st	
UK	1000	1500		p	estimate	naChang	2.0	2013-2024		-30 10 NA	2000-2024		-40 30 NA	48409	#	0.1	2013-2024		0 0 NA	2000-2024		-30 30 NA		#																					Accepter genitalic all st	
PL	5000	8400		p	mean	method	0.9	2013-2024		31 3 18	1980-2024		NA NA NA	110000	#	0.3	2013-2024		NA NA NA	1980-2024		NA NA -44		#																						Accepter genitalic all st
SE	4475	7129	5701	p	interval	genome	0.6	2012-2023		51.3 60.15 10.02	2002-2023		-49.85 87.39 7.58	190000	#	0.6	2012-2024		NA NA NA	1980-2024		21.8 38.1 NA		#																						Accepter genitalic all st
PT			2/01	p	mean	roChang	0.4	2013-2024		NA NA 10.9	2004-2024		NA NA 44	25600			2013-2021		NA NA 44	1999-2021		NA NA 84		#																						Accepter genitalic all st

Member States could provide any complementary and contextual text information for each estimated component (distribution, population size, distribution and population trends). If this information was provided it is indicated by ‘#’ in the corresponding ‘I’ field. The complementary information can be viewed by hovering over the # sign.

Below the Member States reports the EU population assessment is displayed. This includes both the current and previous EU population status. This will normally be one EU line per species but where Sub-specific units have been reported these will all show as in the case of *Accipiter gentilis* below (*Accipiter gentilis*, *Accipiter gentilis arrigonii*, *Acipeter gentilis all others*).

EU population status assessments																				
	Breeding population					Breeding distribution			Winter population							EU population status		Previous status breeding	Previous status wintering	Sup. / subsp. unit
	Population size (max)	Population size (min)	Start	Short term trend	Long term trend	Area	Short term trend	Long term trend	Population size (max)	Population size (min)	Start	Short term trend	Long term trend	Breeding	Wintering					
1027	50000	65000	p	Decreasing	Decreasing	32500000	NE	NE						Near Threatened	Secure			Accipiter gentilis		
1027	50000	65000	p	Decreasing	Decreasing	32500000	NE	NE						Near Threatened	Secure			Accipiter gentilis all others		
1027	140	170	p	Unknown	Unknown	6100	NE	NE						Threatened	Threatened			Accipiter gentilis arrigonii		

Hovering over the population status will display The IUCN categories as below.

EU population status		
trend	Breeding	Wintering
	Near Threatened	
	Near Threatened	
	Threatened	
VU D1		

3. Additional information.

For additional information about how the EU population status assessment was undertaken and the Target 1 reached, as well as additional information on the bird species, the filters below can be used.

[View data sheet info](#)[Audit trail](#)[Map](#)

‘View data sheet info’ provides a general information of the bird species or sub-species assessment, depending on the filter used (e.g. this may include describing the ecological requirements of the species or change in status between reporting periods).

‘Audit trail’ provides a record of the assessors rationale behind the EU assessment. It is only filled in if some additional considerations were taken (e.g. the use of the substitute data, a particular issue of a data quality) in comparison to the general methods document (accessible via the intro page of the tool).

The ‘map’ function can be used to view the distribution of the selected bird species/sub-species.